

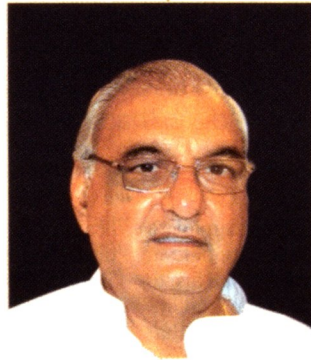


Road to progress

Amanbir Brar/ Aparna Pawar

Road infrastructure is a crucial requirement for economic and social growth. It facilitates the movement of men and material, helps trade and commerce, links industry and agriculture to markets. It helps backward regions get a ray of civilization. The road system also provides last mile connection for other modes of transport; railways and airports. A sound road network is essential since the population of motorised vehicles are constantly growing. Haryana has been energetically developing road network; first state in country to connect every village with a pucca road. Several agencies and a huge man power are engaged in laying and maintaining roads.

The present Haryana Government under the leadership of Mr. Bhupinder Singh Hooda has been very vigorously boosting road infrastructure. It is no surprise that the 1,540 cr. budget during 2009-10 for the improvement of roads is the highest ever. This does not reflect the actual expenditure which is much more as this does not include the monies spent for laying and improving rural roads, state highways under Central Road Fund and upgrading



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**-Bhupinder Singh Hooda
Chief Minister**

National Highways. Stressing his resolve, Chief Minister Bhupinder Singh Hooda says, "The funds are not a problem and we are constantly improving all roads: national highways, state highways, district roads and link roads. Our watchword is progress on all fronts."

Midway during his 5 year term, Mr. Hooda started Rajiv Gandhi Bridges and Roads Infrastructure Development Programme clearly setting his goals. It meant initiating road and bridge projects worth at least Rs. 3,000 crore. This programme was launched by UPA Chairperson Mrs. Sonia Gandhi in Dadri in November 28, 2007. It is his continuous monitoring and motivation that has resulted into achieving the target one year ahead of the schedule.

According to PWD minister, Capt. Ajay Singh Yadav "When the present government assumed office, the planned budget of the Public Works Department, Bridges and Roads, was only Rs 210 crore, which has been increased to Rs 1,540 crore in 2009-10, an increase of more than seven-fold. It depicts the government's will to lay solid base for the galloping economy."

The government's resolve to strengthen the infrastructure is improving the quality of life of its peo-